independent MLAs declared their support for the NDA. Three other parties, each holding a small number of seats, followed. This took the NDA close to securing a majority in the assembly. However, in order to attain a majority, it became clear that the NDA would still require the support of some LJP or RJD or Congress MLAs. Rumours ran rife, as over a dozen MLAs from the LJP – sequestered in resorts just outside Jamshedpur[2] – were apparently being 'induced' to pledge their support to the NDA.

As these events were playing out, Singh sent two further reports to the President. The first was sent on 27 April 2005. The governor warned that the BJP and the JDU were making concerted efforts to win over MLAs from the LJP through 'various means'.[3] This 'unprincipled and opportunistic realignment' was undesirable and would distort the mandate of the electorate, the governor said. The governor concluded with the warning that in order to avoid any further horse-trading, there may be no choice but to organize a fresh round of elections in Bihar.

Singh's next report to the President was sent about four weeks later, on 21 May 2005. By that stage, the governor observed, one LJP MLA had already moved across to the JDU, with a large group of seventeen to eighteen MLAs expected to follow suit upon being offered allurements. The governor therefore recommended that the assembly be dissolved and fresh elections be called in the state.

The UPA government formally received the governor's report the next day. The rumour on the street was that the BJP and the JDU were on the brink of staking claim to the government. The UPA government had just concluded its one-year anniversary celebrations, and an emergency cabinet meeting was called at 11 p.m. that evening to consider Singh's report. The cabinet swiftly accepted the governor's recommendation and forwarded it to President A.P.J. Abdul Kalam for his assent. The President's assent was required for the dissolution of the assembly and the calling of fresh elections. As it happened, Kalam was in Moscow that evening as part of a four-nation official visit to Russia, Iceland, Switzerland and Ukraine. Kalam was woken up in the middle of the night in his room at the Kempinski